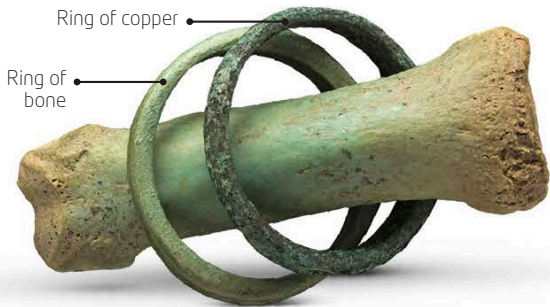


MEDIEVAL MONASTERY

Once a flourishing monastery (a community of Christian monks), Lindisfarne was the scene of one of the first Viking raids in Britain. Almost nothing is visible of the original buildings today so archaeologists are digging deep into the landscape to find clues about this once-famous center of Christian learning and art.



Rings and remains

This pair of rings was found around a fragment of finger bone—probably belonging to a pilgrim (religious traveler) who died at the monastery.



A king's gift

Lindisfarne island lies close to what is now England. The monastery was founded in 635 CE by King Oswald, ruler of the Anglo-Saxon kingdom of Northumbria. He asked a monk called Aidan to set up a community there. The new monastery was located only a few days by sea from Scandinavia—the home of the Vikings.

Anglo-Saxon cash

These coins, from Northumbria and the nearby kingdom of Yorkshire, were of high value. Lindisfarne was rich and attracted many wealthy visitors.



This coin shows the head of an Anglo-Saxon king.

Carved stone

Name stones were used at Lindisfarne to mark a burial place. This one was made from sandstone at around the time of the Viking raid. It would have been brightly painted and may have had a jewel embedded in it.



The stone is carved with "Osgyth," a woman's name.

